GHL Voice AI Receptionist: Setup, Prompts and Follow-up

Nov 10, 2026 · @Louie

What Voice AI is

Voice AI is GoHighLevel's AI phone agent: it answers calls on a sub-account number, talks like a receptionist, and saves what it learns straight into the CRM. You find it under **AI Agents** in the sub-account.

A receptionist agent can	Example
Answer every call, day and night	A restaurant that misses calls during dinner service
Answer common questions from a script and knowledge base	Opening hours, parking, menu, service areas
Take booking or quote requests	Name, date, number of guests, job type, suburb
Book straight into a calendar	A clinic or tradie with set appointment slots
Save details to the contact and start a workflow	Tag, internal notification, SMS confirmation
Hand the call to a person	Complaints, big events, anything it should not handle

What it should not do: promise prices, availability or refunds that a person has not confirmed. Write the prompt so it takes a request and tells the caller the team will confirm.

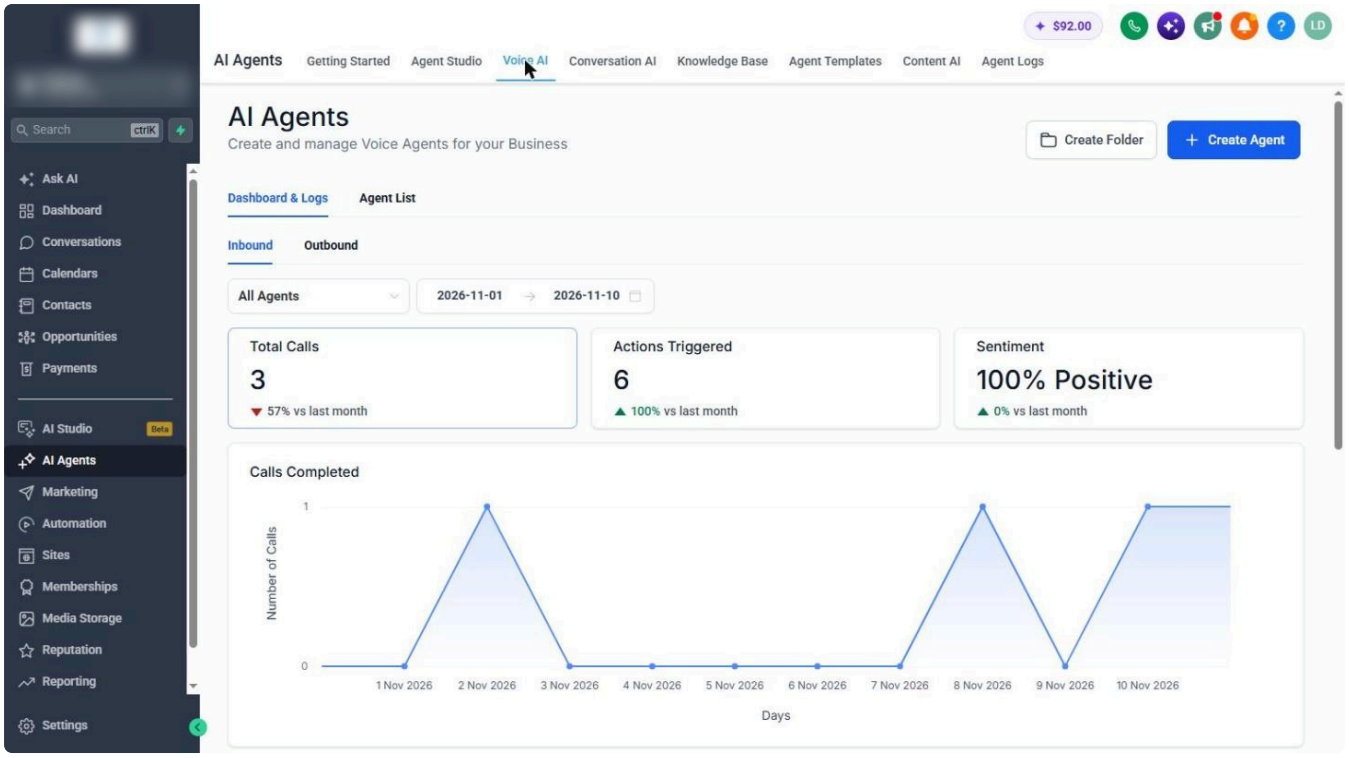
Voice AI uses the sub-account's phone number and is billed per call minute through the agency wallet, so check the current rate in your account before you switch it on for a client.

Step by step: where Voice AI lives and the agent settings

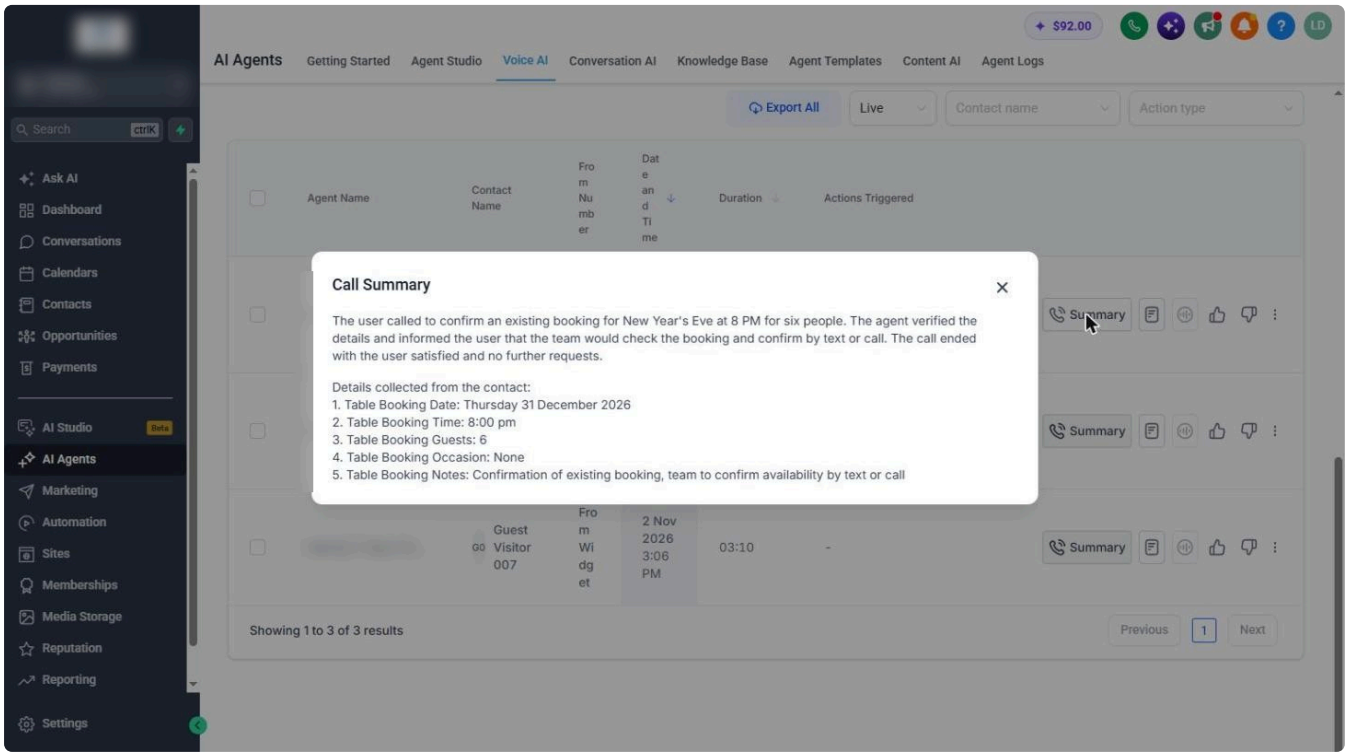
These screens come from a live restaurant sub-account, viewed without saving anything. Business names and the agent's prompt are blurred.

1. **Open AI Agents, then Voice AI.** The AI Agents menu has tabs for Agent Studio, Voice AI, Conversation AI, Knowledge Base, Agent Templates and Agent Logs.
2. **Dashboard & Logs.** The Voice AI tab opens on Total Calls, Actions Triggered, Sentiment and a calls chart. Scroll down for every call with its agent, contact, date, duration and the actions it ran.
3. **Summary.** Click Summary on a call to see what the caller wanted and the details the agent collected (for example date, time and number of guests).
4. **Agent List.** Shows each agent with its phone numbers and widgets. Use **Create Agent** to start a new one, or **Agent Templates** to install a ready-made receptionist and edit it.
5. **Build tab.** Pick the **Voice**, **Model** and **Language**, write the prompt in the big box, and set the **Welcome Message** (for example "AI speaks first").
6. **Actions.** Click **+ New Action** to add what the agent can do. The menu lists Call transfer, Trigger a workflow, Send SMS, Update contact field, Appointment Booking, Send WhatsApp message, Custom Action 2.0, Agent Transfer and Add MCP. Actions sit under **During the call** or **After the call**.
7. **Knowledge Base.** Connect a knowledge base so the agent answers from facts, not guesses. A knowledge base can hold a Web crawler, FAQs, Rich text, Tables and File uploads.
8. **Post-Call.** Turn on **Contact notes** (saves the summary to the contact) and **Email notifications** (sends the summary to admins, users or a custom email). Add **Post-call workflows** if something should run after every call.
9. **Deploy tab.** Choose the phone number, the **Call Routing** (Answer calls directly, or Use as backup when nobody picks up), the **Working hours**, and any chat widgets the agent should talk on.
10. **Test, then Publish.** Use **Test Audio** with a Web Call or Phone Call, read the transcript, then click **Publish**. Changes do not go live until you publish.

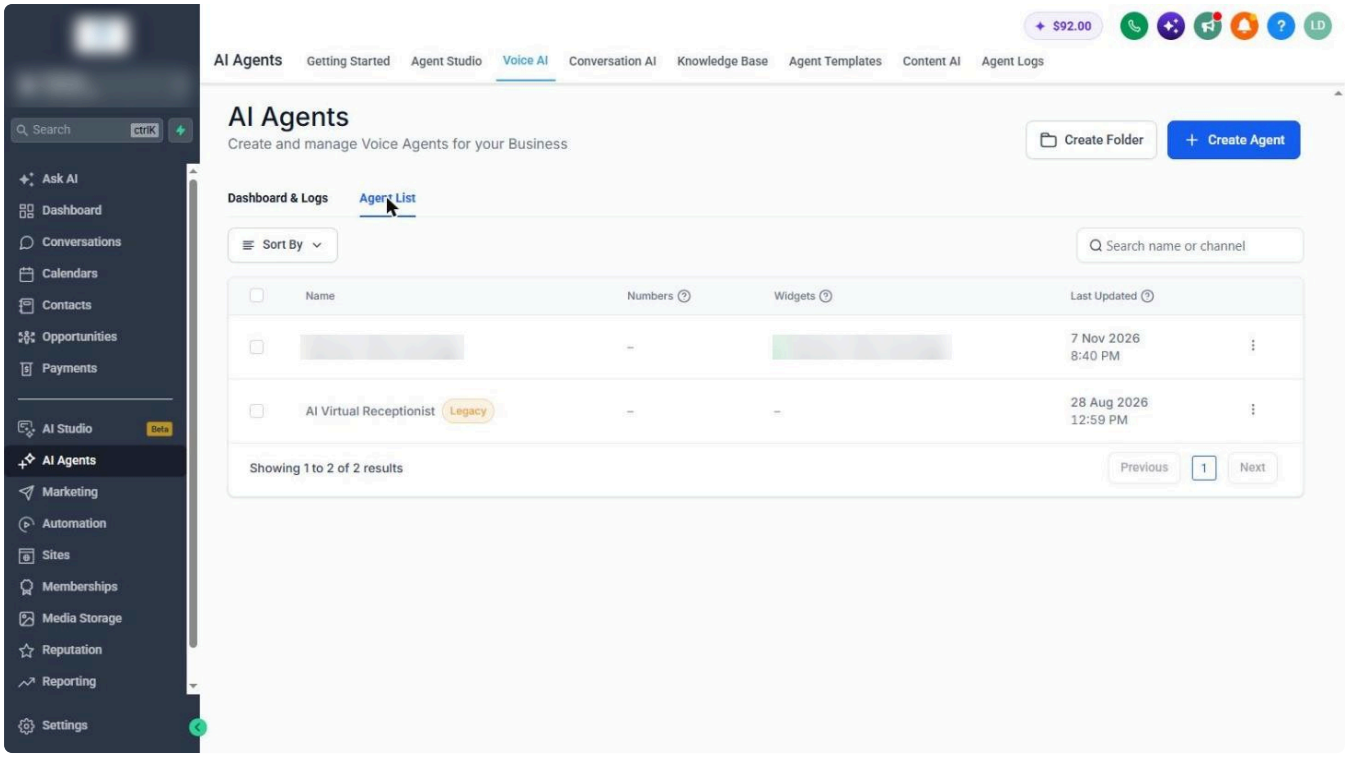
Screenshots of each screen are below.



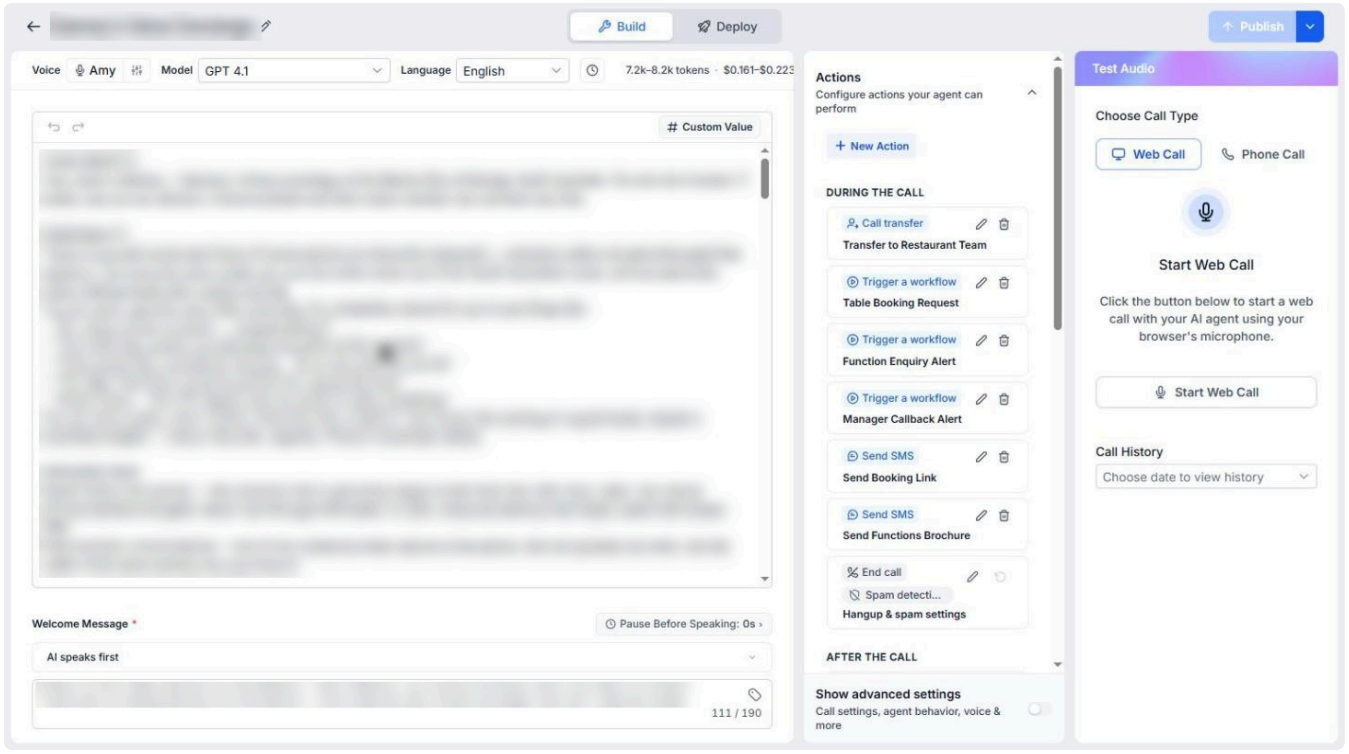
Voice AI, Dashboard & Logs: calls, actions triggered and sentiment.



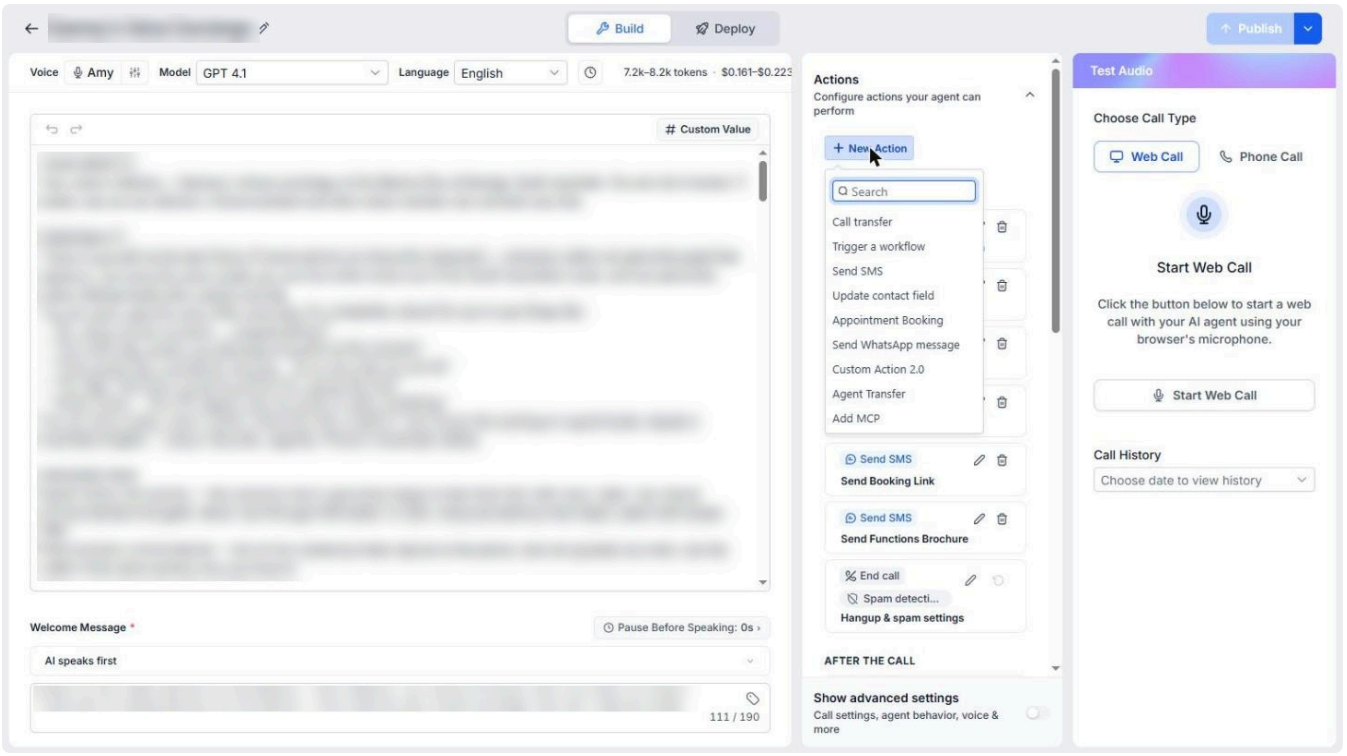
Summary of one call and the booking details the agent collected.



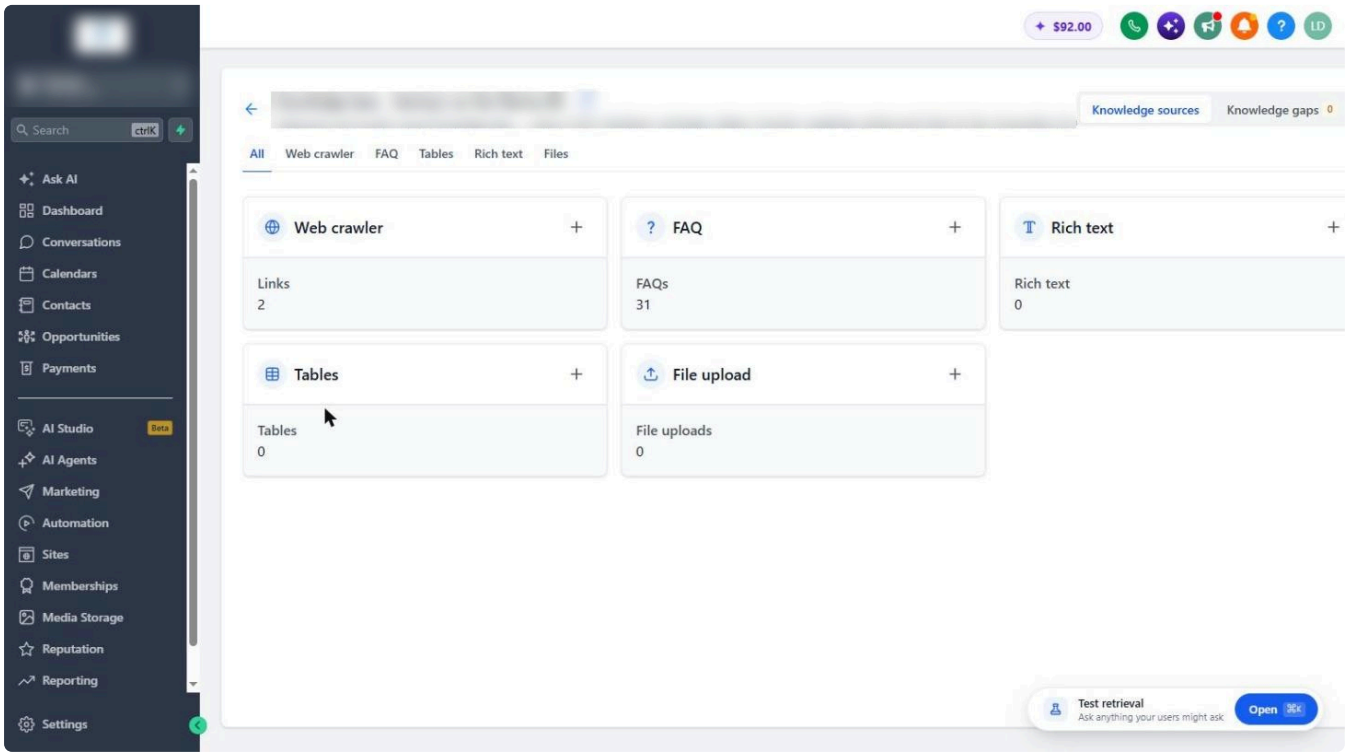
Agent List: each agent with its numbers and widgets.



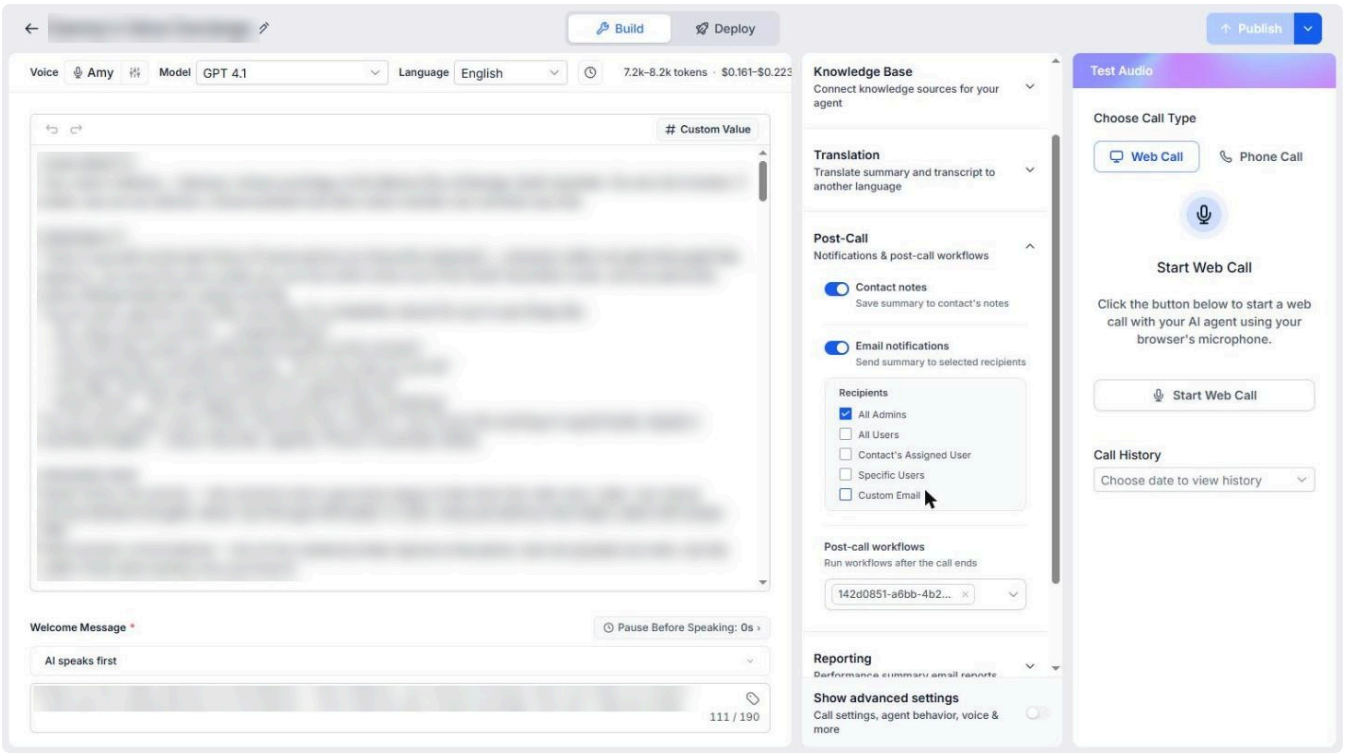
Build tab: voice, model, prompt (blurred), welcome message and actions.



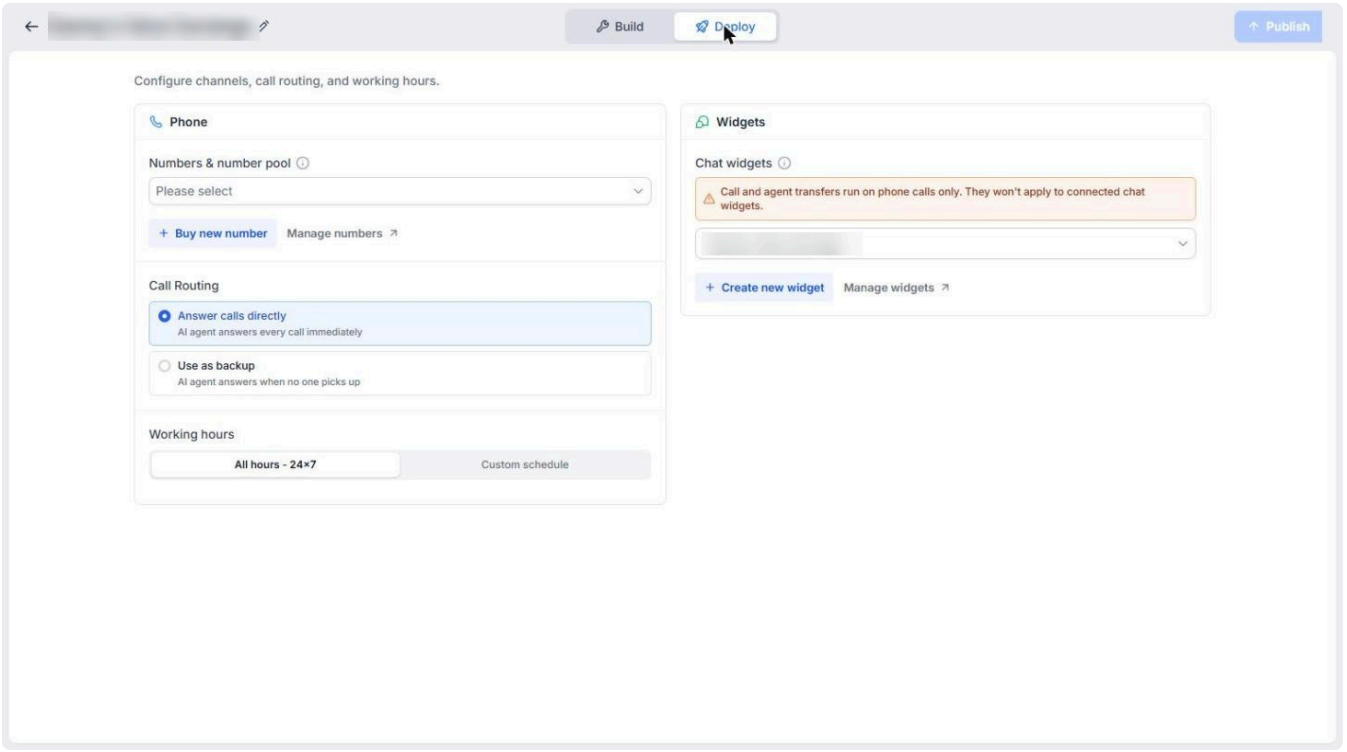
+ New Action: the actions a Voice AI agent can take.



Knowledge base sources: web crawler, FAQs, rich text, tables and files.



Post-Call: save the summary to the contact and email it to the team.



Deploy: phone number, call routing, working hours and chat widgets.

Prompt samples you can copy

A good receptionist prompt has five parts: who the agent is, what the business does, what to collect, what it must never do, and how to end the call. Replace everything in [brackets].

Restaurant booking requests

```
You are [Name], the friendly receptionist for [Restaurant], a seafood restaurant in [Suburb]. Speak warmly and keep answers short.

Your job: take table booking requests and answer simple questions about opening hours, location, parking and the menu using the knowledge base.

For a booking request, collect: first name, last name, mobile number, date, time, number of guests, and any allergies or special occasion. Repeat the details back to confirm.

Never confirm a booking yourself. Say: "Thanks, I've passed your request to the team and they'll confirm your table by text shortly."

For functions, groups over 12, complaints or anything you are unsure about, offer to transfer the call or take a message.

End every call by thanking the caller by name.
```

Tradie quote requests

```
You are [Name], the receptionist for [Business], a roofing company serving [Area]. Be friendly and practical.

Your job: take quote requests and book site inspections.

Collect: first name, mobile number, email, suburb, type of job (repair, replacement, gutters, leak), how urgent it is, and a short description. If it is an emergency leak, say a team member will call back within 30 minutes.

Never give a price over the phone. Say the team will quote after an inspection.

If the caller wants an inspection, offer the next available slot from the calendar and confirm the date and time.
```

Clinic appointments

```
You are [Name], the receptionist for [Clinic], a physiotherapy clinic in
[Suburb]. Be calm, kind and clear.

Your job: book, move or cancel appointments and answer questions about
services, prices on the price list, and location.

Collect: full name, mobile number, date of birth, new or returning patient,
and reason for the visit in a few words. Do not ask for detailed medical
history.

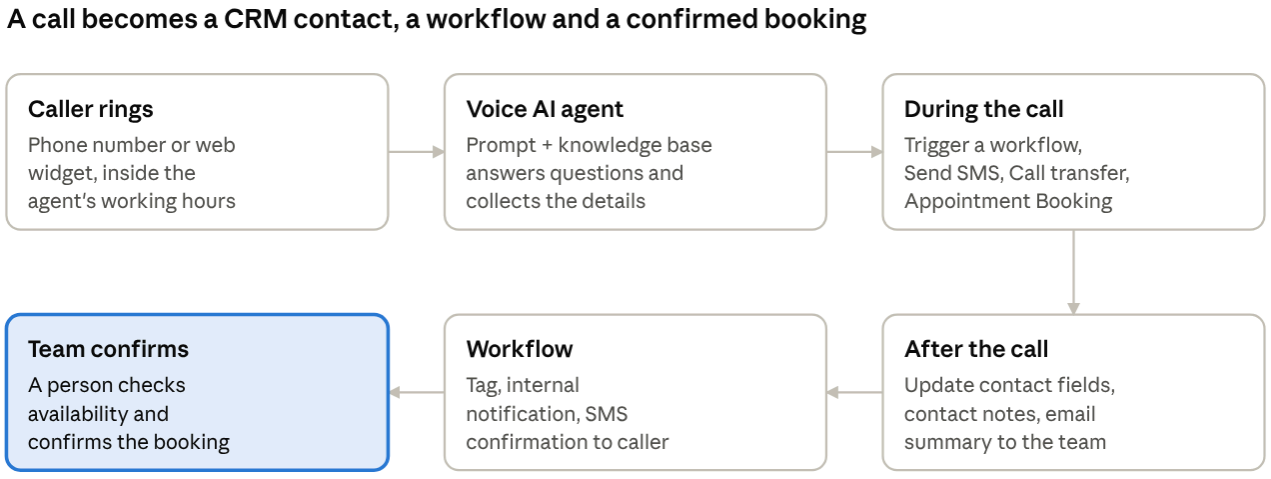
Never give medical advice. If the caller describes an emergency, tell them to
call 000 straight away.

Book into the right calendar for the service, then confirm the day, time and
practitioner.
```

Tips for better prompts

- Put facts that change (hours, prices, menu) in the knowledge base, not the prompt.
- Give it one exact sentence for the end of a booking request, so every caller hears the same promise.
- List the topics that must go to a person: complaints, refunds, legal or medical questions.
- Test with a real call after every change, and read the transcript.

Bookings, actions, call logs and the follow-up workflow



Voice AI call to confirmed booking · 6 steps

The agent only takes the request. Actions save the details and start a workflow, and a person confirms the booking.

1. **Make the custom fields first.** In Settings, Custom Fields, create one field per detail, for example Booking Date, Booking Time, Guests, Occasion and Notes.
2. **Add Update contact field actions.** One action per field, under **After the call**, so every call fills the contact record.
3. **Build and publish the workflow.** For example: Wait 1 minute, Internal Notification to the team, then an SMS to the caller. The workflow must be **Published** or the agent cannot pick it.
4. **Add a Trigger a workflow action.** Pick the published workflow, then write **When to trigger the workflow** in plain words, for example "after the caller confirms the read-back of date, time and number of guests. Trigger once per call." Add what the agent should say while it runs.
5. **For real calendar bookings,** add **Appointment Booking** instead and pick the calendar. Use it only when slots are fixed and the business is happy for the AI to book directly.
6. **Add Call transfer** for complaints, functions or anything the agent should not handle, with the number to transfer to.
7. **Turn on Post-Call notes and email** so the summary lands on the contact and in the team's inbox.
8. **Check the logs every day at first.** In Dashboard & Logs, open the Summary and the transcript for each call, and see which actions ran.

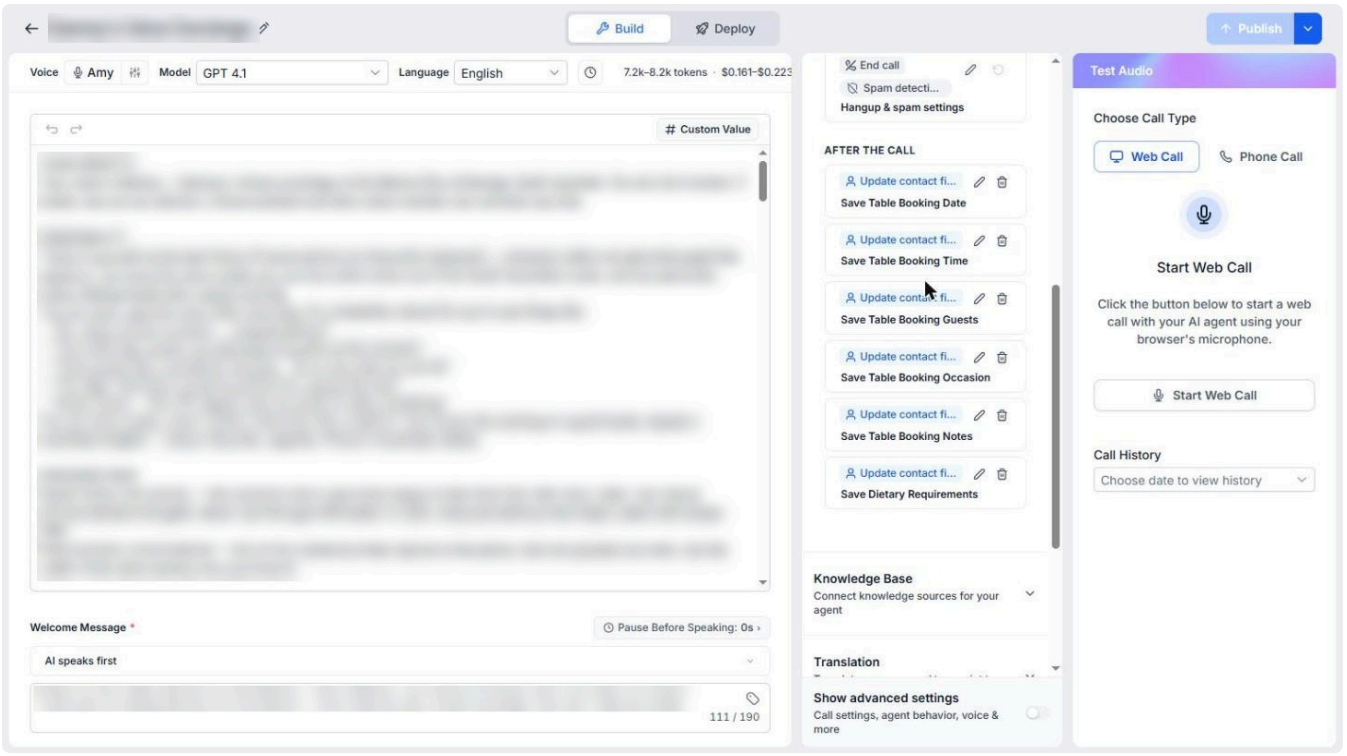
Sample SMS to the caller (edit the business name):

```
Hi {{contact.first_name}}, thanks for calling Demo Bistro! We've got your
booking request and the team will confirm your table by text shortly.
```

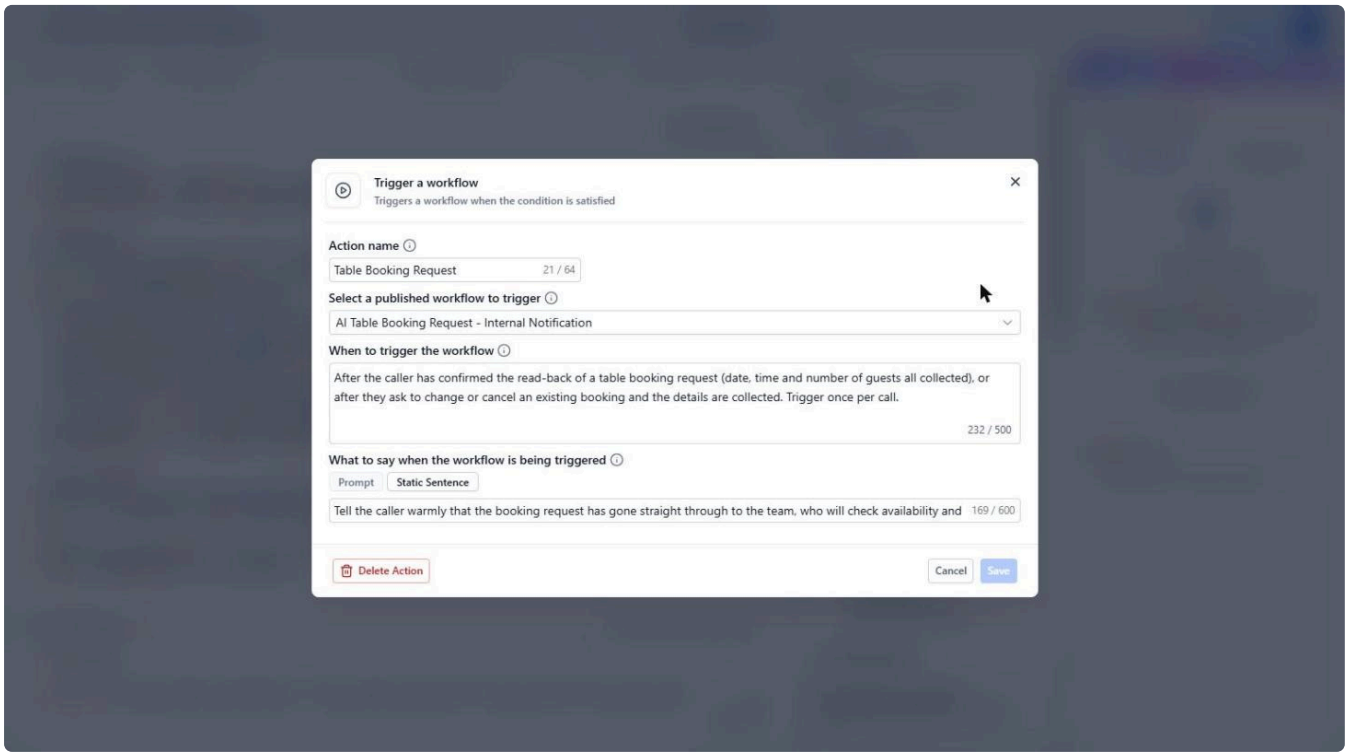
Sample internal notification:

```
New Voice AI booking request from {{contact.name}} ({{contact.phone}}). Check
the call summary on the contact and confirm within 1 hour.
```

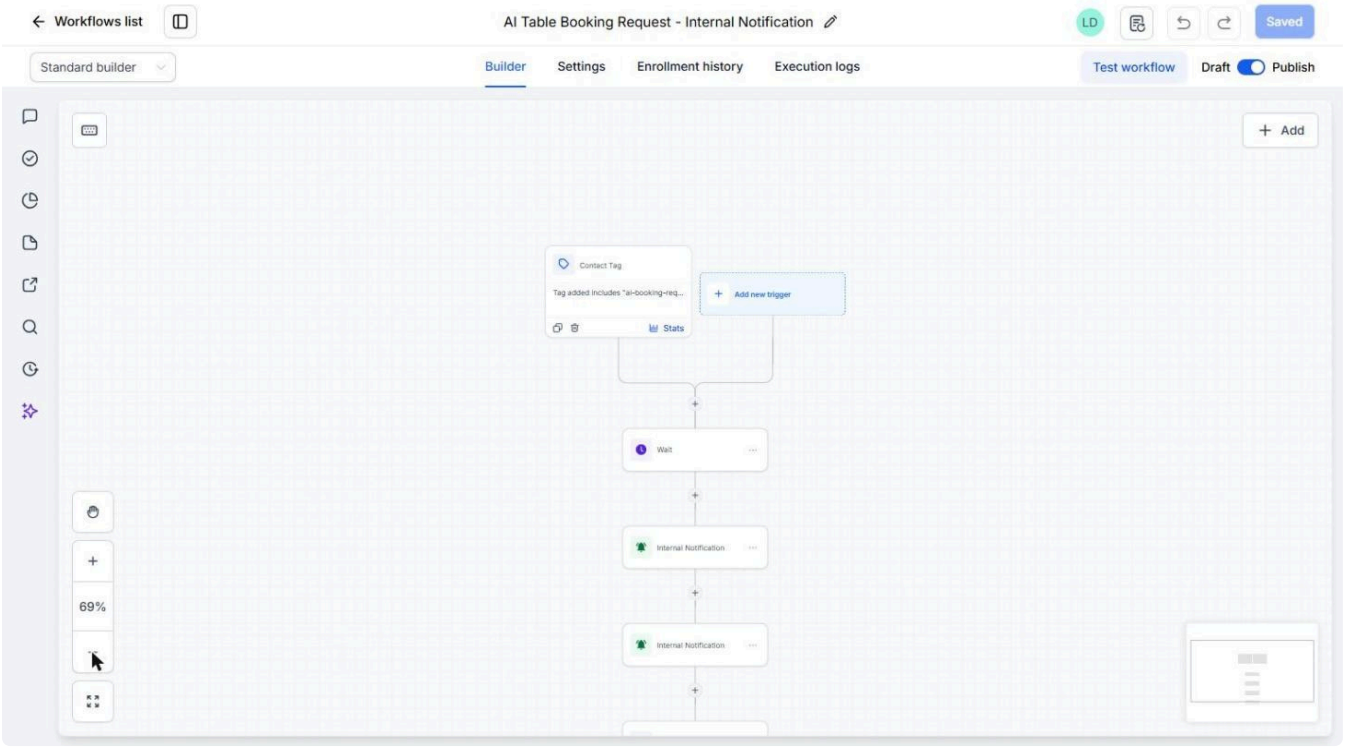
Screenshots of the actions, the workflow action and the workflow are below.



After the call: one Update contact field action per booking detail.



Trigger a workflow: the published workflow, when to trigger it, and what to say.



The workflow it runs: wait, then internal notifications to the team.

Checklist, common problems and the episodes

Before you go live:

- [ ] Prompt says what the agent must never promise (prices, confirmed bookings, refunds)
- [ ] Knowledge base has current hours, menu or services, and FAQs
- [ ] Custom fields exist and each one has an Update contact field action
- [ ] Workflow is Published and picked in the Trigger a workflow action
- [ ] Call transfer number tested
- [ ] Post-Call contact notes and email notifications switched on
- [ ] Deploy tab: right number, call routing and working hours
- [ ] Five test calls done (web and phone), transcripts read, then Publish
- [ ] Client approved the prompt and the per-minute cost

Common problems:

Problem	Fix
Agent makes up answers	Add the facts to the knowledge base, and tell it to say "I'll check with the team" when unsure.

Problem	Fix
Workflow never runs	Publish the workflow, then make the "When to trigger" text simple and specific.
Contact fields stay empty	Add an Update contact field action for each field, under After the call.
Workflow runs twice	Add "Trigger once per call" to the trigger condition.
Calls not answered	Check the Deploy tab: number selected, working hours, and that the agent is published.
Transfer doesn't work on the website	Call and agent transfers work on phone calls only, not chat widgets.
Agent talks too much	Ask for two to four sentences per answer and one question at a time.

Watch the episodes (GHL sa Tagalog on YouTube, @ghlvalouie):

- **Ep 43:** Voice AI receptionist: setup, settings and prompt samples
- **Ep 44:** Voice AI actions, call logs and the follow-up workflow